

Riverside City -- Home Renovation Permit Guide

When You Need a Permit

A building permit is required for any structural changes, electrical rewiring, new plumbing lines, or additions over 120 square feet. Cosmetic work such as painting or flooring does not require a permit.

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Application Process

Permit applications are submitted online through the Riverside Permits Portal and typically reviewed within 15 business days. Incomplete applications are returned with a list of missing items rather than rejected outright.

A licensed contractor's information is required for electrical and plumbing permits, but not for general structural permits.

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Fees and Inspections

Permit fees are based on the estimated project cost, starting at \$85 for projects under \$5,000. At least one inspection is required before a permit is closed out; larger projects may require inspections at multiple stages.